Dataset Details

Open University Learning Analytics Dataset (OULAD) · Local project import

Source and local use

The supplied OULAD.names file describes data about students, course presentations, assessments, and VLE interactions. The local importer creates 32,593 student-course-presentation profiles. Course presentation suffixes B and J are described in the source documentation as February and October presentations. Official project information: analyse.kmi.open.ac.uk/open_dataset. Citation: Kuzilek, Hlosta & Zdrahal, Scientific Data 4, 170171 (2017), doi:10.1038/sdata.2017.171.

Format and purpose

Seven comma-separated CSV tables with header rows. They are used here to build historical student-course profiles for academic and engagement trend review, metadata filtering, similarity search, risk-screening demonstrations, and support suggestions.

CSV file	Local rows	Imported use
studentInfo.csv	32,593	Student demographics, education, credits, attempts, final result
studentRegistration.csv	32,593	Registration / withdrawal dates
studentAssessment.csv	173,912	Assessment submissions, scores, banking flags
assessments.csv	206	Assessment schedule, type, weight and join IDs
studentVle.csv	10,655,280	Student VLE clicks by site/day; streamed and aggregated
vle.csv	6,364	Site metadata and activity type
courses.csv	22	Module-presentation durations

Key field names

Student/course keys: id_student, code_module, code_presentation. Filters: region, highest_education, age_band, studied_credits, num_of_prev_attempts. Assessment: id_assessment, date_submitted, score, is_banked, weight. Activity: id_site, date, sum_click, activity_type. Course metadata: module_presentation_length. These source columns are joined and aggregated into the profile fields below.

Import command

From backend/: python scripts/ingest_oulad.py ../open+university+learning+analytics+dataset. Import is repeatable and refreshes matching IDs instead of duplicating them.

Derived fields

- Assessment score: mean of available scored submissions (unweighted). Score trend: later-half mean minus earlier-half mean when both exist.
- Activity: total clicks, active weeks and relative click change between halves of observed activity days.
- Completion: fraction of presentation assessments with a scored submission. Outcome and source metadata are retained.
- Student identifiers are combined with module/presentation so repeated learners remain distinct by course presentation.

Important limitations

- Assessment average is not an official weighted module mark; assessment weights are not applied by the importer.

- VLE clicks indicate recorded activity only, not comprehension, effort, or causation.
- The local release has its own measured row counts; do not substitute counts from a different OULAD release.
- Treat anonymized student-level rows as sensitive. Follow source license and institutional data-governance rules before redistribution or operational use.

Reference

Official dataset page: https://analyse.kmi.open.ac.uk/open_dataset · Publication DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/sdata.2017.171